



Plants for colorful stems

As temperatures plummet and deciduous plants lose their leaves, a few species choose to put on their best performance of the year.

Twig dogwoods decorate winter gardens with spiky bouquets of scarlet, gold, and lime-green stems, while the stark white trunks of Himalayan birches make ghostly silhouettes in barren landscapes. Other plants produce intricately patterned bark to make your garden sparkle. The stems of snake bark maples resemble that reptile's skin, while the London plane tree's multicolored stems look like designer wallpaper—only select this large tree if you have plenty of space. Bamboos work well in modern, minimalist planting schemes—their graphic stems injecting a hint of gold, blue, or apple green.



TREE SMALL

Acer palmatum 'Sango-kaku'

CORAL-BARK MAPLE The coral-red stems of this small deciduous tree look great when combined with its yellow leaves in fall. The lobed foliage unfurls pinkish yellow in spring and turns green in summer.

±25ft (8m) ↔12ft (4m)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z6–8



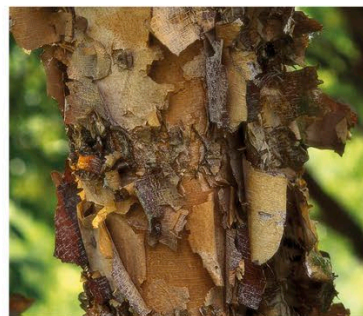
TREE MEDIUM

Acer pensylvanicum

SNAKE BARK MAPLE An upright deciduous tree with green- and white-striped bark, which looks beautiful year-round, and rounded green leaves that turn yellow in fall. 'Erythrocladum' (above) has reddish brown and white-striped bark.

±40ft (12m) ↔30ft (10m)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z3–7 (N)



TREE LARGE

Betula nigra

RIVER BIRCH The reddish brown peeling bark of this upright deciduous tree makes a focal point in winter gardens and looks good all year, especially when contrasted with the yellow spring catkins. Its diamond-shaped green leaves turn yellow in fall.

±50ft (15m) ↔30ft (10m)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z4–9 (N)



TREE LARGE

Betula utilis var. *jacquemontii*

HIMALAYAN BIRCH Grown for its white trunk and stems, this deciduous tree looks stunning from winter to spring when yellow catkins appear. The diamond-shaped leaves turn yellow in fall. Choose multistemmed forms for small gardens.

±60ft (18m) ↔30ft (10m)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z4–7



TREE MEDIUM

Acer capillipes

SNAKE BARK MAPLE This stunning deciduous tree features decorative green- and gray-striped bark and has an elegant spreading habit. The three-lobed dark green leaves turn spectacular shades of orange and red in fall.

±30ft (10m)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z5–7



TREE MEDIUM

Acer griseum

PAPER-BARK MAPLE This spreading deciduous tree is grown for its distinctive bronze flaking bark that can be seen most clearly in winter after the leaves have fallen. The lobed, dark green decorative foliage turns bright orange and red in fall.

±30ft (10m)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z4–8



BAMBOO LARGE

Chusquea culeou

CHILEAN BAMBOO Best on free-draining soils, this clump-forming bamboo produces glossy yellow-green to olive-green canes with long, papery-white leaf sheaths, giving young canes a striped appearance. It has midgreen linear leaves. Ideal for screening.

±15ft (5m) ↔8ft (2.5m) or more

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z8–11



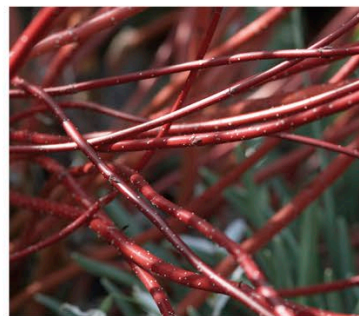
ANNUAL/BIENNIAL SMALL

Beta vulgaris

SWISS CHARD Grown as an edible crop, this annual has brightly colored stems in shades of red, orange, and yellow and can be treated as an ornamental. Sow seeds from spring to summer for color all year. Plant it at the front of a bed or in pots.

±18in (45cm)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️



SHRUB LARGE

Cornus alba

TATARIAN DOGWOOD Grown for its bright red winter stems, this deciduous shrub looks good year-round. It bears flattened heads of white flowers in early summer; the leaves turn yellow, orange, and red in fall. Cut the stems to the ground in late winter.

±10ft (3m)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z2–7